

A reminder of the Northumbria Password Rules:

Each password must contain at least 12 characters, and a combination of at least three out of four rules;

- uppercase characters (A through to Z)
- lowercase characters (a through to z)
- numerical digits (0 through to 9)
- non-alphabetical characters (eg. ! \$ # % @ +)

Passwords should also be changed when there is reason to believe a password has been compromised. In addition, every account should have a different, unique password. Users with Domain Admin secondary accounts must use different passwords to their personal accounts.

In line with guidance from the National Cyber Security Centre (NCSC) our advice on password selection is to use three random words; for example, “train”, “York”, “piano” to create a password of “trainyorkpiano”, adding in some capitals, digits and symbols. Three well-chosen random words can be quite memorable but not easy to guess. It provides a good compromise between protection and usability. You are advised not to add a number to the end of your existing password and increment this at each change, as this is very easy to guess if your password is compromised.

This guidance is in line with the Password Reset Policy, which you can view by clicking this link: [Northumbria University Password Policy](#)

Resetting your Password

You can change your password in a number of ways:

1) Via the Update Password website

- Click the following link: <https://sts.northumbria.ac.uk/adfs/portal/updatepassword>
- Enter your current password.
- Enter a new password.
- Click **Submit** to save it

2) On a Northumbria Mac device (this is only if you're on campus. If you're off campus, please see Point 3 to reset via MyAccess)

- Go to **System Preferences > Users and Groups > Change Password**
- Follow the on-screen steps to change your password.

3) Via MyAccess

- Login to MyAccess at <https://myaccess.northumbria.ac.uk>
- Click the cog in the top right-hand corner and select **Account Settings**
- Select **Change Password**
- Enter your current password and a new one
- Click **OK** to save it
- Click the cog in the top right-hand corner again and select **Log off**

4) On a Northumbria Windows device

- Press **CTRL + ALT + DEL** at the same time on your keyboard

- Select **Change A Password**
- Enter your current password and a new one
- Click the arrow (submit) to save it..

Common password reset issues

If you experience issues with your password during or after a reset, below is a list of some of the most common issues we see

Issue	Recommendation/ Action
Failure to meet the minimum Criteria	• Your password must be 12 characters with 3 of the 4 following types - lower, upper, numeric, non-alphabetic • Avoid using any of your names (forename, middle, surname) within your new password
Cache	Your old password might be cached, this means it is stored by your device. Logoff and try again ensuring you use your new password when logging back in.
Sync	Once your password has been changed it may take some time for the new password to sync across all of your NU systems (e.g. OneDrive), please be patient. We recommend the best way to reduce the possibility of sync issues is to use the update password tool .
MAC Devices	MAC users aren't able to reset their password using the CTRL-ALT-DEL option. If you use a MAC, please see alternative ways to reset your password above.

Further Guidance

In line with guidance from the National Cyber Security Centre (NCSC) our advice on password selection is to use three random words; for example, "train", "York", "piano" to create a password of "trainyorkpiano", adding in some capitals, digits and symbols. Three well-chosen random words can be quite memorable but not easy to guess. It provides a good compromise between protection and usability. You are advised not to add a number to the end of your existing password and increment this at each change, as this is very easy to guess if your password is compromised.

Self-Service Password Reset

If you ever forget your password, you can reset it yourself without needing to contact IT if you have Duo push notifications enabled on your mobile phone.

Reset your password at: www.northumbria.ac.uk/PasswordReset